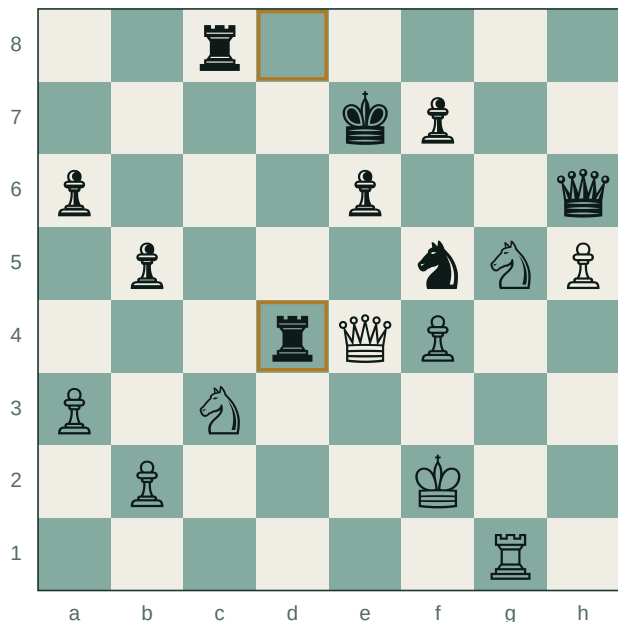


Forks and double attacks: White, move 35

Forks and double attacks

White to move



Previous move: 34...Rxd4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

35. Qb7+ Rd7 36. Qxc8

35.Qb7+ Check restricts Black to 7 legal replies here. From b7 it attacks king on e7 and rook on c8. Recorded reply: **35...Rd7**.

36.Qxc8 The queen captures the rook on c8.

At the end, nominal material is White 24 / Black 21 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +5: the balance goes from -2 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Two attacked pieces do not guarantee a gain if the forking piece can be captured or one target moves with check.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A fork attacks multiple targets at once. The combination works when the defender cannot save everything or generate a stronger forcing reply.

HOW TO LOOK

Look for checking forks first, then double attacks on queens, rooks, and undefended pieces. Follow the line until the material is actually collected.

The defending king is on e7. Absolute pin: pawn on e6.